

The Value Of Following A Leader:

In the second chapter of 2 Kings we are introduced to two men, Eijah and Elisha. Elijah was an older prophet who was wrapping up his public ministry. Elisha had been serving Elijah for about ten years.

Elisha had witnessed the ministry of Elijah up close and personal. He listened and observed as this man prophesied things that came to pass, spoke into the lives of religious leaders and kings, as well as performing miracles. **The miracles he witnessed included: (PLACE ON SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Three and one half year drought... 1Kings 17:1, James 5:1
- Meal and oil multiplied... 1 Kings 17:14
- Child restored to life... 1 Kings 17:22
- Sacrifice consumed by fire... 1 Kings 18:38
- Captains and men slain by fire... 2 Kings 1:10
- Drought ended... 1 Kings 18:4
- Water of Jordan divided... 2 Kings 2:8

Elisha had been following this vision for more than ten years and in 2 Kings chapter two, Elijah knew he was about to be taken to heaven and he said to Elisha, “*Stay here, please, for the LORD has sent me on to Bethel.*”

When we are committed to following a vision there will be plenty of stops along the track where we will be given an opportunity to disconnect and go our own way. (LEAVE ON SCREEN UNTIL NEXT SLIDE)

Elisha was a true disciple and was not about to let the vision fail after ten years of pursuit! His words are the words of a focused servant who would not allow the vision to fail! “*As the LORD lives, and as your soul lives, I will not leave you!*”

What seems menial today could be the very thing that positions us for greatness tomorrow. (LEAVE ON SCREEN UNTIL NEXT SLIDE)

Three times in one day Elisha had to decide to stay or pursue the man of God from:

- Gilgal to Bethel...
- Bethel to Jericho...
- Jericho to Jordan...

When they arrived at the Jordan Elijah struck the river with his mantle and the river parted allowing them to walk across on dry ground! Eventually – after ten years – Elijah asked Elisha what he wanted? Think about this. This discussion had not been had for ten years! Elijah had followed the man of God and pursued the vision of someone else for ten years without ever bringing up what he was going to get out of it.

Elisha answered immediately – ***“I want a double portion of what you have!”***

What a request! Who asks for such a thing? Elijah was the most powerful prophet in Israel

in decades if not centuries. Most of us would have asked for: (PLACE ON SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)

- His influence...
- His connections...
- His church...
- His anointing...

To ask for a double portion is genius! To my surprise Elijah laid out the perimeters of the fulfillment of his request. ***“If you see me when I am taken away, it will be so, but if you do not see me when I am taken away, it will not be so!”*** Here is the practical application for us: (PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)

- Following a vision short term does not produce much... (The son’s of the prophet did not get a blessing like this)
- Following a vision with a personal agenda cannot produce a double portion...
- Stopping short of the completion of a vision cancels a generational blessing...

- A double portion blessing can only be conveyed to those who follow the vision to the end of the road...

How we respond to the commands (or demands) of a leader is directly tied to the amount of honor we show, and our honor will determine how much victory we can achieve.

I seriously doubt Elisha blinked the rest of the day! (You gotta want it to win it, and we want it bad) Getting up under the vision of a leader positions us to fulfill our own vision!

Key leaders cannot expect to be positioned for success unless and until they have served the vision of a spiritual father. As we push our leader forward, God will push us forward.
(LEAVE ON SCREEN UNTIL NEXT SLIDE)

Elijah was taken into Heaven by a chariot and horses of fire and Elisha witnessed the whole thing.

With the Jordan bible school students looking on, Elisha went back to the river and took the mantle of Elijah and struck the river saying, ***“Where is the Lord God of Elijah?”*** The water parted and Elisha walked across on dry ground! The generational blessing had become a reality for a man who followed a visionary leader for ten years. Generational blessings are always imparted to those who place fulfilling the vision of a leader ahead of fulfilling their own vision.

Summary

Following a vision all the way to the end paid off for Elisha. Elisha said, ***“Where is the Lord God of Elijah?”*** I believe God is asking, *“Where are the Elisha’s of the Lord God in this generation?”*

Where are the men and women who are willing to see a vision through to its successful conclusion? They say there is a pot of gold at

the end of the rainbow – I doubt that – but I can promise you there is a payday at the end of the race for those who support the vision of a visionary leader.

Remember: (PLACE ON SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)

- What we make happen for someone else, others will make happen for us...
- We cannot expect to realize the fulfillment of our own vision until we have helped someone accomplish theirs...
- When we get ourselves stitched into the fabric of a seamless vision, the double portion is produced... Elisha performed twice as many miracles as Elijah.

Can you imagine what could be accomplished if several generations could link arms, going after the fulfillment of a vision?